it to fashion social policies designed to reduce religious tensions. It should also support ongoing efforts toward Indo-Pakistani rapprochement on the fraught question of Kashmir. However, it should avoid the temptation, however well meaning, to insert itself as a broker in this dispute.[14] The “shadow of the past”—to reverse Robert Axelrod’s proposition—looms large in India about the United States’ role in resolving the Kashmir dispute.[15] Indian policymakers still recall the crude Anglo-American attempts to induce India to settle the Kashmir dispute on terms favorable to Pakistan in the wake of the disastrous Sino-Indian border war of 1962.[16]

At a regional level, much depends on the evolution of the existing political order in Pakistan. If democracy remains fledgling and anemic within Pakistan, the military is likely to undermine any imaginative moves toward the resolution of the Kashmir dispute. On the other hand a consolidation of democratic rule in Pakistan could provide the basis of a sustained dialogue with India and an eventual settlement of the dispute. Similarly, weak and fractious coalition regimes in India could also impede progress on the Kashmir question. This is especially true because any negotiations on Kashmir would involve discussions at two levels: bilateral and domestic.[17] Any regime in New Delhi would have to conduct complex negotiations with Pakistan. It would also have to pursue discussions with various disaffected parties within Indian-controlled Kashmir to ensure that they would not derail negotiations with Pakistan.

What would constitute a settlement of the Kashmir dispute? The precise contours of such a resolution are virtually impossible to delineate. However, it is possible to outline some general principles that might serve as useful guidelines for its settlement. First, it would require Pakistan to end its support for and involvement with a range of jihadi organizations. As long as the Pakistani state relies on this option no regime in India will be prone to making any meaningful concessions. Second, Pakistan will need to accept that there will not be significant changes in the territorial status quo. It has resorted to war with India on four occasions (1947–48, 1965, 1971, and 1999) and has used a strategy of asymmetric warfare since 1989 but to little effect. After fending off repeated Pakistani depredations with the expenditure of much blood and treasure over six decades, no regime